Employee Handbook

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. | Version 3.2 | January 2026

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a fictional company. This document is sample data for GenAI / RAG practice.

1. Welcome to NovaTech

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. was founded in 2018 in Hyderabad, India, and builds cloud analytics software for healthcare and retail clients. We have 240 employees across Hyderabad, Pune and Bengaluru. Our values are Curiosity, Ownership, Integrity and Collaboration. This handbook applies to all full-time employees and is effective from 1 January 2026.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

• Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, with a one-hour lunch break.

• Core hours, when everyone must be reachable, are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM.

• Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager approval. New joiners must work from office for the first 30 days.

• Late arrival beyond 30 minutes more than 3 times in a month is counted as half-day leave.

• Employees must log attendance daily in the HR portal, "NovaHR".

3. Leave Policy

Leave Type	Days per Year	Rules
Casual Leave	12	Max 3 consecutive days. Cannot be carried forward.
Sick Leave	10	Medical certificate required for more than 2 consecutive days.
Earned Leave	18	Accrues 1.5 days per month. Up to 30 days can be carried forward.
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	As per the Maternity Benefit Act. Applies to first two children.
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth.
Bereavement Leave	5	For immediate family members.
Marriage Leave	5	One-time, for the employee's own marriage.

Leave must be applied in NovaHR at least 3 working days in advance, except for sick or emergency leave. Unused casual and sick leave lapse on 31 December. Public holidays: the company observes 12 public holidays per year, published each January.

4. Compensation and Benefits

4.1 Salary and Payroll

Salaries are paid on the last working day of each month via bank transfer. Salary slips are available in NovaHR by the 3rd of the next month. Performance reviews and increments happen once a year in April, effective 1 April.

4.2 Benefits

• Group health insurance of INR 5,00,000 covering employee, spouse and two children, fully paid by the company.

• Personal accident insurance of INR 10,00,000.

• Provident Fund: 12% of basic salary by both employee and employer.

• Learning allowance: INR 30,000 per year for courses and certifications, reimbursed after submitting the certificate.

• Meal card of INR 2,200 per month and a home-office setup allowance of INR 15,000 (one-time).

• Referral bonus: INR 25,000 if a referred candidate completes 6 months with the company.

5. Code of Conduct

All employees must treat colleagues, clients and partners with respect. NovaTech has zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination or bullying. Employees must not share confidential client data on personal email, WhatsApp or any unapproved tool. Conflicts of interest, such as working for a competitor, must be disclosed to HR in writing. Gifts from clients worth more than INR 2,000 must be declared.

6. Information Security

• Use only company-issued laptops for client work. Disk encryption must remain enabled.

• Passwords must be at least 12 characters and changed every 90 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory.

• Report lost devices or suspected phishing to security@novatech.example within 1 hour.

• Do not paste client data into public AI tools. Use the approved internal assistant "NovaGPT" instead.

7. Performance Management

Performance is reviewed twice a year: a mid-year check-in in October and an annual review in March. Ratings use a 5-point scale: 1 (Needs Improvement), 2 (Partially Meets), 3 (Meets), 4 (Exceeds), 5 (Outstanding). Employees rated 1 enter a 60-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) with weekly manager check-ins.

8. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Item	Limit	Notes
Domestic flight	Economy class	Book at least 7 days ahead.
Hotel (metro city)	INR 6,000 per night	Approved by manager.
Hotel (other city)	INR 4,000 per night	
Daily food allowance	INR 1,000	When travelling outside base city.
Local conveyance	Actuals with receipts	Cab apps preferred.

Expense claims must be submitted within 15 days of travel in the "NovaExpense" module with original receipts. Claims above INR 20,000 need department head approval. Reimbursement is processed within 10 working days.

9. Notice Period and Exit

• Notice period: 60 days for all employees; 90 days for Team Leads and above.

• Notice buy-out is allowed with manager and HR approval.

• Full and final settlement is completed within 45 days of the last working day.

• Exit interview is conducted by HR during the final week. Laptop, ID card and access cards must be returned on the last day.

10. Grievance Redressal

Employees can raise concerns with their manager, then HR Business Partner, then the Grievance Committee. Contact HR at hr@novatech.example or extension 1100. Complaints about harassment go to the Internal Committee (POSH) at posh@novatech.example, which acknowledges within 48 hours and completes inquiry within 90 days.